respond to Raymond's SOS call overran a motorcyclist who died on his way to hospital.

The US government claimed that Raymond Davis was a diplomat. The government of Pakistan did not confirm it and maintained that he was a contractor working for the US Consulate General Lahore. Later, the matter went to the court. A back-channel effort worked, and the relatives of the boys killed by Raymond Davis agreed to forgive him in lieu of blood money. It was perfectly legal as Pakistan's law has the provision of blood money known as '*dyat*'.

Such issues and public perceptions, at times arising out of half-truths, are problematic for the governments of Pakistan and the US in implementing continuous and uninterrupted coordination against terrorism.

Another irritant between Pak-US relations had been the Haqqani network or group that operated from the Pak-Afghan border for Al Qaeda and with the help of TTP. The US strongly believed that Pakistan's intelligence agencies backed the group. This simmering irritant flared up after a Taliban attack on the US Embassy and NATO HQ in Kabul on 12 September 2011. The US authorities blamed the Haqqani group for organising this attack and lashed out at Pakistan for its support to the group. In a scathing and unprecedented public condemnation of Pakistan, Admiral Mike Mullen said that the country's Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI) was actively supporting Haqqani network extremists who, he said, have targeted US forces in Afghanistan. Mullen told the Senate Armed Services Committee that 'The Haqqani Network, for one, acts as a veritable arm of Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence agency'. The US threatened to attack North Waziristan, from where the Haqqani group was suspected to be operating and the US Senate Committee voted to make economic and security aid to Pakistan conditional on its cooperation in fighting militants such as Haqqani. Pakistan rejected these allegations, and the Interior Minister said, 'the Pakistan nation will not allow the boots on our ground, never. Our government is already cooperating with the US but they also must respect our sovereignty' (*Asian Tribune,* 2009). In fact, Pakistan forces were already busy as it had been constantly fighting with TTP militants in FATA. Opening up another front in North Waziristan would mean inviting more trouble.

Prof Anatol Lieven had been indicating this scenario for quite some time fearing US incursion of US forces into Pakistan.